

Permissions

Every file and directory within the FreeBSD environment is associated and linked with a defined set of permissions. Subsequently, there exist various utilities that one can use to both view and modify these permissions. At the outset, it is important to develop a sound understanding of how permissions function to ensure that users remain confined to accessing only those files that are earmarked for them and are kept from foraying into those that are either marked for other users or

meant solely for the usage of the operating system. The basic permissions in UNIX are allocated by making use of three types of access- read, write, and execute. In addition to defining file permissions, FreeBSD also supports the use of ‘file flags,’ which introduces an additional layer of security and lets one exercise greater control over the files in the system.



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Every FreeBSD file and directory is governed by a set of permissions

Directory structure

One needs to be familiar with the FreeBSD directory hierarchy to develop a complete and in-depth understanding of the system. A list of the most common directories and their descriptions has been provided below for the reader's reference.

- `/` The file system's root directory.
- `/bin/` User utilities that are common to both single and multi-user environments.
- `/boot/` Programs and configuration files that are utilised during operating system bootstrap.



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A directory hierarchy is at the core of the FreeBSD operating system